



Figure 6: Types of triggers



Figure 7: Periodic trigger time settings

automate the invocation process as well, so that you can configure the action and forget it once and for all.

A periodic trigger would be the best option. It triggers the action based on a specific time, and will retweet the latest tweets with 'Serverless' in it. One can either choose a pattern

or write a cron expression.

The pattern shown in Figure 7 will invoke the TweetBot action every week day (Monday to Friday) every six hours, keeping your Twitter account live without your intervention!

Words of caution

Before we end this article, here are a couple of things you should be careful about:

1. OpenWhisk is open source and free, but to deploy it, we use IBM Bluemix which isn't free. The TweetBot action will seamlessly run in the free tier, but for any other application, please estimate the monthly costs. The pricing calculator (<https://console.bluemix.net/openwhisk/learn/pricing>) could be handy.
2. This action uses the Twitter API in the background via the *TwitterFollowBot* module. Misusing this may lead to the banning of your Twitter app, so please make sure you clearly read the Twitter automation rules (<https://support.twitter.com/articles/76915>).

In this article, we discussed a TweetBot that can be written to automatically retweet the latest tweets with certain given hashtags. We wrote the actions (serverless functions) in Python, and deployed them in OpenWhisk on IBM Bluemix. We also used triggers to automatically invoke the actions at specified time intervals. With this introduction, we invite you to further explore OpenWhisk as well as other exciting serverless technologies. 

References

- [1] Apache OpenWhisk: <https://openwhisk.incubator.apache.org/>
- [2] IBM Bluemix Functions: <https://console.bluemix.net/openwhisk/>
- [3] Twitter API: <https://dev.twitter.com/rest/public>

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